



Myths and legends exist in all walks of life. This is especially true with something as popular as video games, which have grown exponentially in the few decades that they've existed. Let's go ahead and debunk them.

POKEMON – LAVENDER TOWN SYNDROME

You wouldn't normally associate a word as dark as suicide with a Pokemon game, but that's exactly what happened with the very first Pokemon games in the series. We're talking about Pokemon Green, Red and Blue. Lavender town was a pain to get to, but once you got there things went from being a pain to plain depressing. This was basically a ghost town, and a



pokemon graveyard. However, the thing that really unsettled players was the creepy soundtrack. The Japanese version (Green) was apparently so creepy and horrifying that it made kids go crazy and drove them to suicide in the hundreds! While the kids committing suicide part is completely untrue, the music was retuned for global

release because it actually was a tad jarring on the ears.

MADDEN – THE MADDEN CURSE

A pretty well known myth, but probably something most of us wouldn't really be bothered about since it concerns the NFL. Dubbed the Madden Curse, it was basically a myth that athletes from the NFL featured on the game's cover were cursed and would get injured the following season. This apparently happened for several years in a row, to the point where fans would lobby against their favourite players showing up on the game's cover. Here's the thing, the NFL is a very

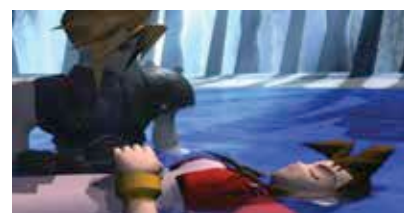


rough sport, and injuries happen frequently. It's safe to say that it was all just a coincidence.

FINAL FANTASY VII – SAVING PRIVATE AERITH

The original Final Fantasy VII for the PlayStation is a classic, and a game that both introduced and popularised the JRPG genre to the western masses. It was a game with an epic story and a memorable cast of characters, both companions and villains. One of the protagonist's closest companions was the young flower seller, Aerith. Over the course of the game, both the protagonist Cloud, and you the player, got to know Aerith better, as she joins your cause to take down the megacorporation Avalanche. The game then pulls the carpet out from under you when she's murdered by the game's primary antagonist Sephiroth, in a move no one was expecting. This devastated most of the people playing the

game, and rumours and myths quickly started spreading that you could actually save Aerith. Steps included doing crazy amounts of grinding and convoluted steps and even being able to sacrifice Tifa instead of Aerith. Well, they were all nothing more than myths. There was no other alternative, Aerith had to die and that was that.



MINECRAFT – HEROBRINE IS COMING

Of all the myths and legends surrounding Minecraft, the biggest is probably Herobrine. Herobrine is a character that resembles the default Minecraft



Steve, but has glowing white eyes. He is said to be a ghost that haunts single-player Minecraft worlds and disrupts player builds and constructs weird structures. We say ghost because the myth is that Herobrine is the ghost of Minecraft creator Markus Persson's dead brother. Spooky for sure, but completely untrue. Markus Persson has denied the existence of Herobrine, heck, he never even had a brother.

STREET FIGHTER 2 – YOU MUST DEFEAT SHENG LONG!

In Street Fighter 2, Ryu had a line which said "You must defeat Sheng Long to stand a chance". That clearly